9 Now we need to cut the spigot to size so the lid will fit, this needs to be a tight fit to enable the lid to be finished. See panel 1 for how I fit lids. Don't be afraid to keep stopping the lathe and trying the fit

10 Once it's fitted tightly to the base, the lid is ready for shaping. The tailstock is in place to give more security while the main turning is completed. Start shaping the lid curve with the bowl gouge working from the centre to the outside. The centre part will be completed once the tailstock is removed

11 After removing the tailstock you can finish the top. Take light cuts only, remember you are holding on a friction fit. Once you have the shape use a scraper to refine the surface, this should leave a surface with no lumps or bumps. Place a little step in the centre for detail

12 I am using a Jacobs chuck in the tailstock with an 8mm drill bit to drill a hole for the finial. Drill this hole 5mm deep, place a piece of tape around the drill bit to give a depth stop if needed. If you go too deep you will drill through the lid. Sand and seal the lid

13 Remove the lid so you can finish the inside of the base. Look for a smooth curve from the rim into the centre of the base. Once you have completed this with the bowl gouge, move to the scraper to finish off. As before sand and seal the inside of the base

14 Mount a piece of scrap MDF in the chuck, in this case it is held with a screw chuck. Cut a recess that the base rim will fit into, this needs to be a tight fit. Do wear dust protection when turning MDF products

15 Hold the base in the MDF. Use the tailstock for additional support. Start to shape the outside of the base, turn down the MDF backing plate to give more room to finish the joint area. Look for a nice curve on the underside of the base; leave the spigot for the foot

16 In this photo you can see the shaving coming off the bowl gouge just below the tip of the tool. This gives a shear cut to give a better surface finish

HANDY HINTS

3. Always wear safety glasses or a face shield. This is so important when using superglue, the surface may be dry, but when you turn the lathe on it may spray some your way if you turn the top surface away
4. Don't part a long way into a grove, the forces can catch you out due to tool overhang. Be safe – stop the lathe and saw through

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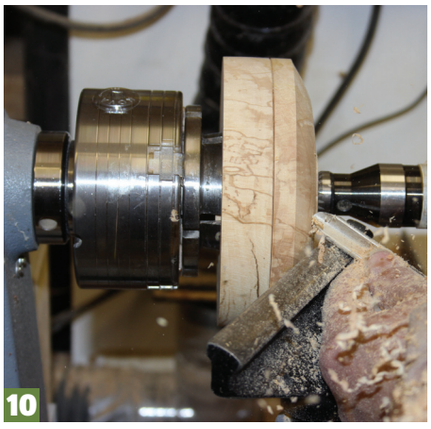
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